

ServiceNow Ui Actions

UI Action Overview

UI Actions are interactive elements in ServiceNow that allow users to manually trigger actions. They can appear as **buttons, links, form context menu items, or list menu options**. UI Actions can execute **client-side scripts, server-side scripts, or both**, depending on the requirement. They are typically created by **System Administrators or developers** to improve the usability, customization, and interactivity of the platform.

Difference Between UI Actions and Business Rules

- **Business Rules**
 - Execute automatically based on conditions.
 - Run when records are inserted, updated, deleted, or queried.
 - Used for automating business logic without user intervention.
- **UI Actions**
 - Execute when a user clicks a button, link, or menu item.
 - Require user interaction to trigger the logic.
 - Used when users need control over when an action occurs.

Example

Business Rule:

- When an Incident state changes to "Resolved", automatically set the Resolved Date.
- No user action is required.

UI Action:

- A "Resolve Incident" button on the Incident form.
- When the user clicks the button, the incident is resolved and related actions are performed.

UI Action Controls

We can create UI Actions in the following places:

- A button on a form View.
- A context menu item on a form that appears when you open the form context menu or right-click the form header.
- A related link in a form.
- A button in the banner on top of a list.
- A button at the bottom of a list.
- A context menu item on a list that appears when you open the list context menu or right-click the list header.
- A menu item for the action choice list at the bottom of a list.
- A related link at the bottom of a list.

Form UI Actions

Form UI Actions appear as buttons or context menu items directly on the Incident form, such as Update, Resolve, Delete buttons and Related Links like Show SLA Timeline and Repair SLAs.

List UI Action

List UI Actions appear in the list view context menu or as actions on selected rows, such as Archive Record, Delete, Follow on Live Feed, Repair SLAs, Add to Visual Task Board, and Create Application File.

UI Action on Server-Side

ServiceNow **Admin** or **Developer** can create new UI Action or modify existing one.

Exercise-1

There should be a button on Incident form to assigned ticket to current logged in user.

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition**→**UI Actions**
2. Click on **New**
3. Fill UI Action form
4. **Name:** Assigned to CLU
5. **Table:** Incident
6. **Order:** 100
7. **Action Name:** Assigned_to_clu
8. **Show Update:** Checked
9. **List Context Menu:** Checked
10. **Active:** Checked
11. **Form button:** checked
12. **Show update:** checked

Script

```
current.assigned_to = gs.getUserID();  
current.update();
```

13. Click on **Submit**
14. Test the Result: open **Incident.list** → **open any Record**
15. Check the **Form button (Assigned to CLU)**

UI Action on Client-Side

UI actions can also be executed on the client-side, as demonstrated in the example below.

Exercise-2

There should be a button on Incident form to assign the ticket to current logged in user.

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition**→**UI Actions**
2. Click on **New**
3. Fill **UI Action** form
4. **Name:** Auto Assignment Incident
5. **Table:** Incident
6. **Order:** 790
7. **Action Name:** Auto_assignment
8. **Show Insert:** Checked
9. **Show Update:** Checked
10. **Client:** True
11. **List v2 Compatible:** True
12. **List v3 Compatible:** True
13. **Active:** Checked
14. **Form Button:** True
15. **Onclick:** autoAssignment()

Script

```
function autoAssignment() {  
    var user = g_user.userID;  
    g_form.setValue('assigned_to', user);  
}
```

```
        g_form.setValue('work_notes', "such as  
assigning to me");  
        g_form.save();  
    }
```

16. Click on **Submit**
17. Test: open Incident.list → open Recored
18. Form button click : Auto Assignment Incident check result

Exercise-3

There should be a button on incident form to create new **Child Incident** from being on the Parent incident form. Once created child incident immediately it should be redirect to child incident.

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition→UI Actions**
2. Click on **New**
3. Fill **UI Action** form
4. **Name:** Create Child Incident
5. **Table:** Incident
6. **Order:** 800
7. **Action Name:** create_childIncident
8. **Show Update:** Checked
9. **Active:** Checked
10. **Form button:** True

Script

```
var inc = new GlideRecord("incident");
inc.initialize();
inc.short_description =
current.short_description;
inc.category = current.category;
inc.subcategory = current.subcategory;
inc.caller_id = current.caller_id;
inc.opened_by = gs.getUserID();
inc.impact = current.impact;
inc.urgency = current.urgency;
inc.parent = current.sys_id;
var sysID = inc.insert();
gs.addInfoMessage('New Child Incident ' +
inc.number + ' created');
action.setRedirectURL(inc);
action.setReturnURL(current);
```

11. Click on **Submit**
12. Test: open Record → create new Child Incident
13. Verify in **Incident.list** (using **Number**)

Exercise-4

There should be a UI action on incident record to create 3 incident tasks automatically associated with same incident.

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition→UI Actions**
2. Click on **New**
3. Fill **UI Action** form
4. **Name:** Create Incident Tasks
5. **Table:** Incident
6. **Order:** 840
7. **Action Name:** create_incident_task
- 8.
9. **Show Update:** Checked
10. **Active:** Checked
11. **Form button:** True

Script

```
var shortDesc = ['Incident Task1', 'Incident Task2', 'Incident Task3'];
for (i = 0; i < shortDesc.length; i++) {
    var gr = new GlideRecord('incident_task');
    gr.initialize();
    gr.short_description = shortDesc[i];
    gr.description = current.short_description;
    gr.incident = current.sys_id;
    gr.insert();
}
action.setRedirectURL(current);
```

12. Click on **Submit**
13. Check the **result**
14. Open Incident.form → create incident task button → check the result under the **Related list** → **Incident Tasks**

Exercise-5

Create a new UI Action to open the problem form from an Incident table record.

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition** → **UI Actions**
2. Click on **New**
3. Fill **UI Action** form
4. **Name:** Open Problem Form
5. **Table:** Incident
6. **Order:** 890
7. **Action Name:** open_problem_form
8. **Show Insert:** Checked
9. **Show Update:** Checked
10. **Active:** Checked
11. **Form button:** True

Script

```
var url = '/problem.do?sys_id=-1';  
action.setRedirectURL(url);
```

12. Click on **Submit**

Exercise-6

Create a new UI Action to send a notification to the caller about incident state changes.

1. **Create Event Registry**
2. **Create Email Notification**
3. **Create UI Action**

Creating Event Registry

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Policy**→**Events**→**Registry**
2. Click on **New**
3. **Event name:** Send the notification to assigned to
4. **Table:** Incident
5. **Fired by:** UI Action
6. **Description:** Create new UI Action to send notification to caller about incident state changes
7. Click on **Submit**

Creating Notification

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Notification**→**Email**→**Notification**
2. Click on **New**
3. **Name:** State Change to IN progress
4. **Table:** Incident
5. **Active:** True
6. **Category:** Uncategorized
7. **Send when:** Event is fired
8. **Event name:** send.notification.assignedto

9. **Users:** Srinivassnow2115gmail.com
10. **Send event creator:** true
11. **Subject:** State changes to in-progress state:\${state}
12. **Assigned to:** \${assigned to}

Creating UI Action

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition→UI Action**
2. Click on **New**
3. Fill UI Action form
4. **Name:** State set to in-progress
5. **Table:** Incident
6. **Order:** 100
7. **Action Name:** state_inprogress
8. **Show Update:** Checked
9. **Active:** True
10. **Form button:** True

Script

```
current.state = 2;  
current.update();  
gs.eventQueue('send.notification.assignedto',current,gs.getUserName());
```

11. Click on **Submit**

Exercise 7

UI Actions on Client and Server side

There should be a UI Action on incident table to Resolve incident ticket.

Procedure

1. Navigate to **System Definition**→**UI Actions**
2. Click on **New**

Name: Resolve

Table: Incident [incident]

Order: 100

Action name: resolve_incident

Active: Checked

Show insert: Checked

Show update: Checked

Client: Checked

Onclick: resolveIncident();

Condition: new global.IncidentUtils().canResolveIncident(current)

Script

```
function resolveIncident(){
    //Set the 'Incident state' and 'State'
    values to 'Resolved', and display mandatory
    fields
    g_form.setValue('incident_state', 6);
    g_form.setValue('state', 6);
    g_form.setValue('resolved_by',
g_user.userID);
    gsftSubmit(null, g_form.getFormElement(),
'resolve_incident');
```

```
        //MUST call the 'Action name' set in this UI  
Action  
    }
```

```
//Code that runs without 'onclick'  
//Ensure call to server-side function with no  
browser errors
```

```
if (typeof window == 'undefined')  
    serverResolve();
```

```
function serverResolve(){  
    current.incident_state =  
IncidentState.RESOLVED;  
    current.state = IncidentState.RESOLVED;  
    current.resolved_by = gs.getUserID();  
    current.update();  
}
```